

AN ILLUSTRATIVE AFTER-HOURS CULTURE GUIDE

NIGHT SHIFT

PRINT PRODUCTION PROTOTYPE / 2026

THE CITY STARTS AFTER SIX.

NIGHT SHIFT

PRINT OBJECT / PRODUCTION NOTE

Night Shift is a self-directed print-production prototype for a fictional after-hours culture guide. The venues, routes, schedules, and participation figures are illustrative. The artifact has not yet been physically printed; the photographs in this case study are rendered production mockups built from the final files.

FORMAT

5.5 x 8.5 in

BINDING

Saddle stitch

PAPER

80 lb uncoated text / 100 lb cover

PAGES

20

COLOR

CMYK, full color

COMPANION PIECES

11 x 17 foldout + 3 postcards + belly band

MOVE THROUGH THE NIGHT.

04	THE CITY AFTER SIX
06	VENUE TYPES
08	ROUTES & ARRIVALS
10	BARRIERS TO ACCESS
12	EVERYDAY NIGHT CULTURE
14	VOICES & LISTINGS
17	TWO NIGHTS OUT
19	PRODUCTION NOTES



ROUTE



EVENT



OPEN LATE



EDITORIAL

THE CITY AFTER SIX.

01

A portrait of public life after work: venues, rituals, movement, and the small decisions that make a night fe

The night is not a gap between work and sleep.

After-hours culture is often described as entertainment, but the experience begins earlier: deciding whether a route feels safe, whether a ticket fits the week, whether a friend can join, and whether there is enough energy left to cross the city. Night Shift treats those choices as part of the cultural experience. It organizes venues and events by mood, duration, price, and transit—not only by category. The guide is

designed to be folded, marked, carried, and kept. Its visual language mirrors the city after dark: sharp signals, layered light, crowded posters, and moments of sudden quiet.

"A useful guide does not only say what exists.
It helps someone imagine getting there."

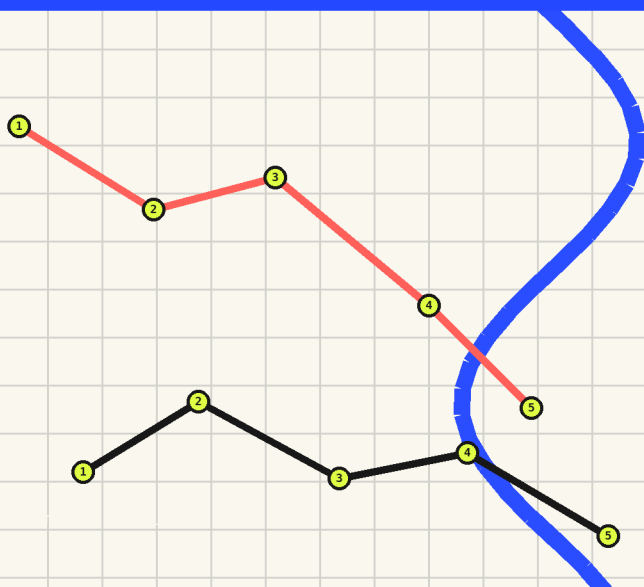
PROJECT PRINCIPLE / 01

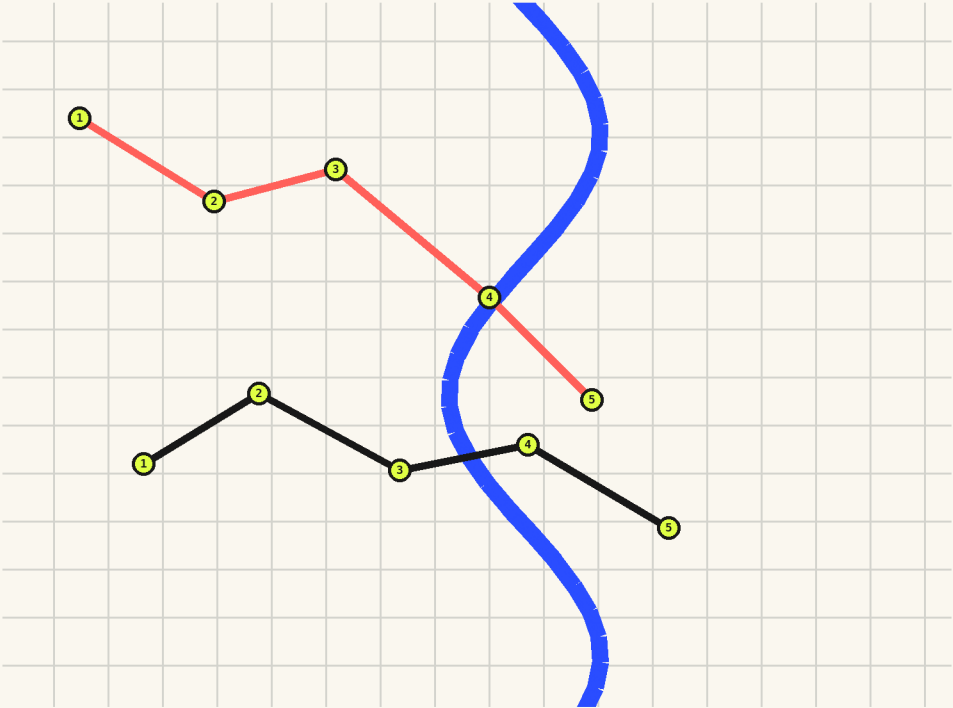
WHAT KIND OF NIGHT IS THIS?

01	LISTEN music, readings, talks	
02	LOOK film, galleries, projections	
03	MAKE workshops, studios, open tables	
04	MOVE dance, performance, late routes	

FOLLOW THE SIGNAL.

TWO ROUTES / SIX STOPS / ONE FOLDOUT MAP





ROUTE A

LOUD / FAST / SOCIAL

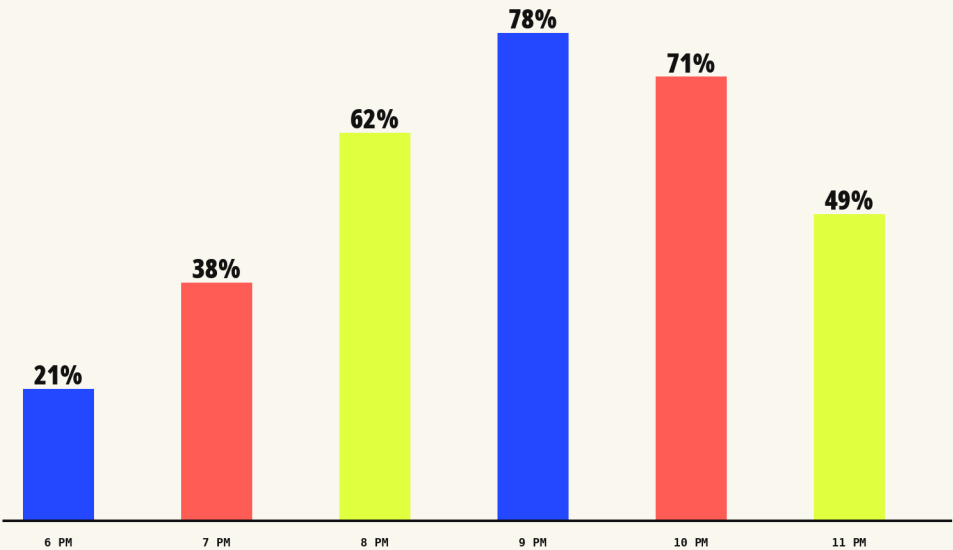
Signal Room → Red Line Cinema → South Loop Roof

ROUTE B

QUIET / SLOW / CURIOUS

Night Library → East Dock Studio → Blue Hour Hall

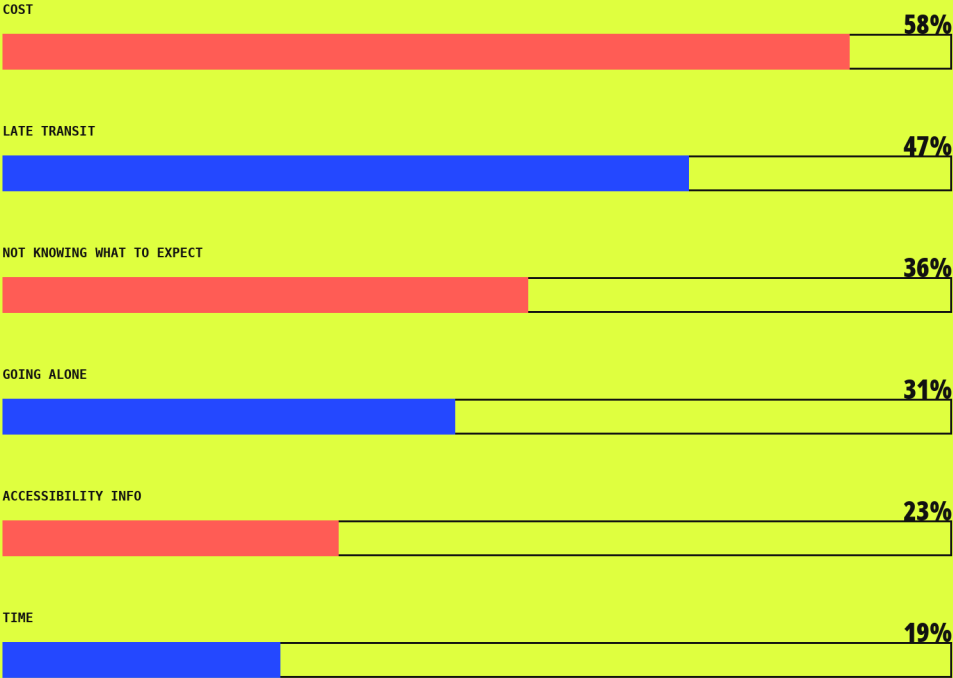
WHEN PEOPLE SHOW UP.



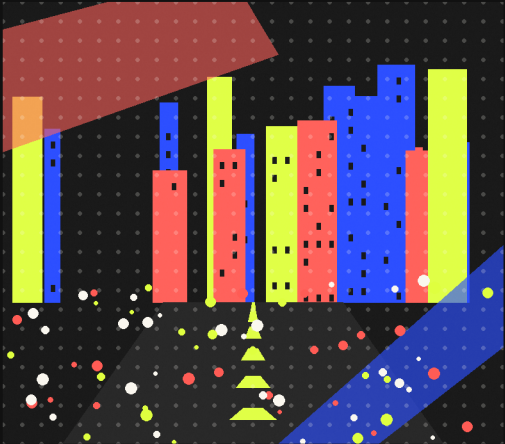
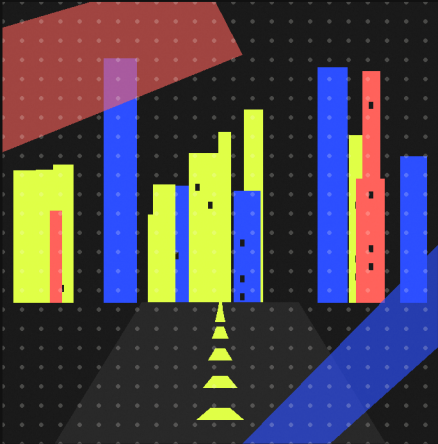
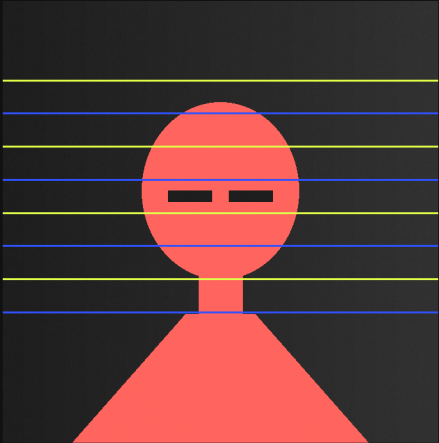
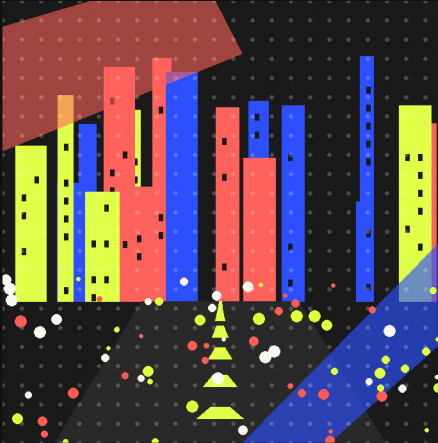
Peak arrival is not the same as peak participation. People arrive earlier when transit, food,

ILLUSTRATIVE SURVEY / N=120

WHAT STOPS A NIGHT OUT?

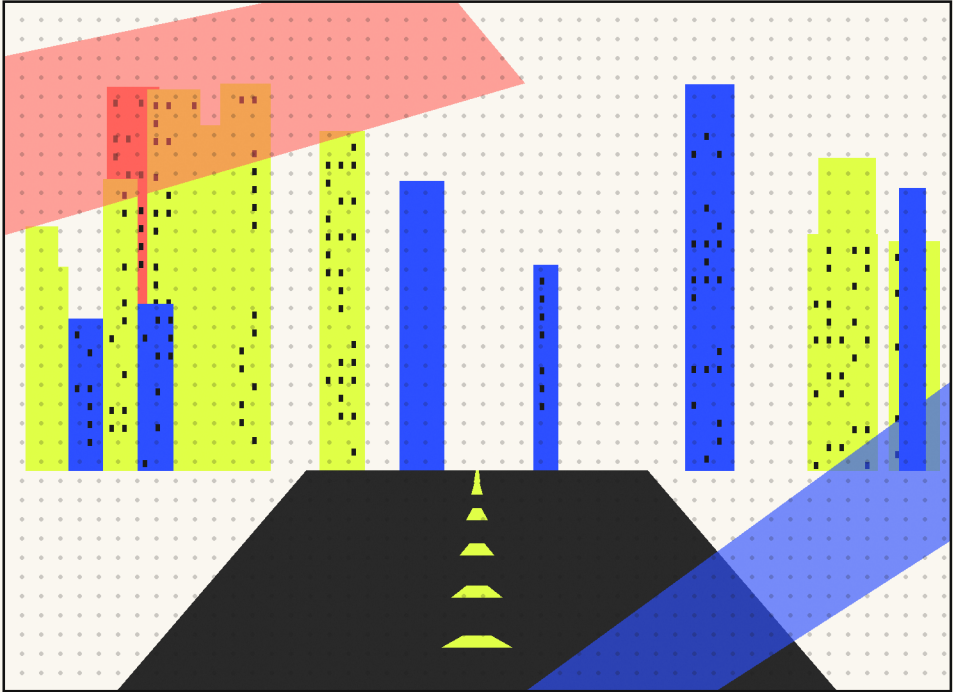


EVERYDAY NIGHT CULTURE



01 / WAITING OUTSIDE 02 / OPEN MIC 03 / LAST TRAIN 04 / PUBLIC DANCE FLOOR

THE CITY FEELS DIFFERENT WHEN YOU STAY.

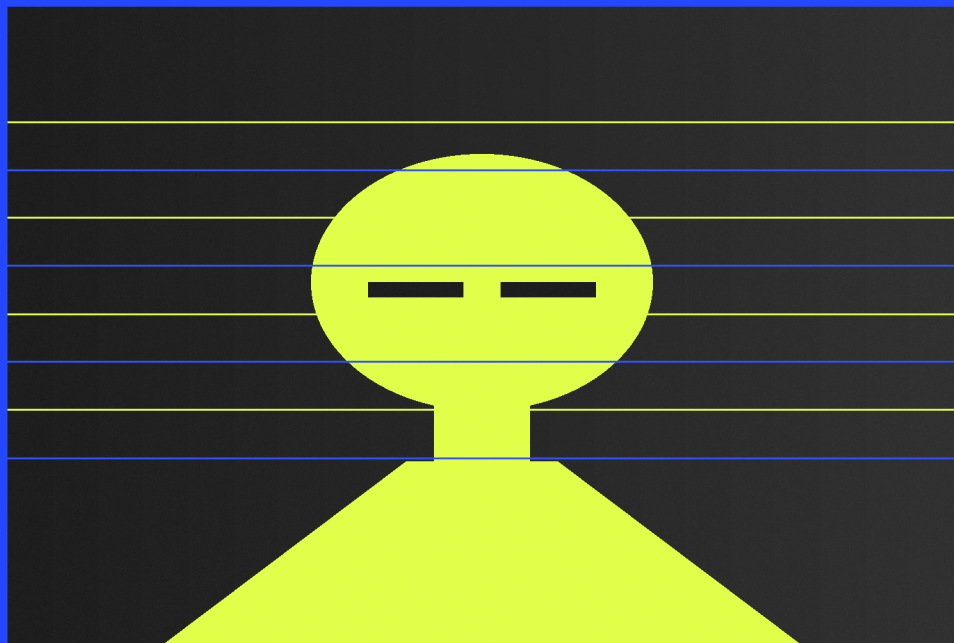


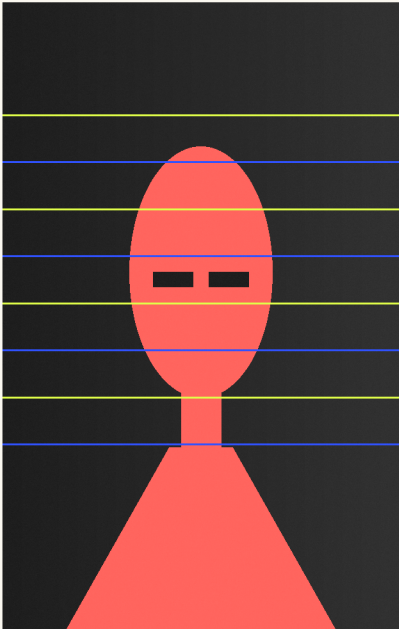
“The best nights are not always the biggest. They are the ones where the city

MODELED PARTICIPANT VOICE / 27 / SOUTH SIDE

WHO MAKES THE NIGHT?

ARTISTS / ORGANIZERS / AUDIENCES / WORKERS





MAYA / 29

COMMUNITY PROGRAMMER
WEST SIDE

"I do not need another list of events. I need t

For Maya, the deciding information is practical and emotional at the same time: whether there is seating, how long the event lasts, whether leaving early feels awkward, and whether the venue explains access needs clearly. Night Shift brings those details into the same hierarchy as date, price, and location.

DESIGN RESPONSE

→ MOOD TAGS

→ DURATION

→ ACCESS NOTES

→ LEAVE-EARLY FRIENDLY

→ LATE-TRANSIT WARNING

WHAT IS ON / WHAT IT FEELS LIKE

FRI 7:00	BLUE HOUR CINEMA Short films + conversation CALM / 90 MIN / \$8
FRI 8:30	SIGNAL ROOM Live electronic set LOUD / 2 HR / \$14
SAT 6:00	NIGHT LIBRARY Poetry + late reading room QUIET / OPEN END / FREE
SAT 7:30	EAST DOCK STUDIO Print workshop HANDS-ON / 2 HR / \$12
SAT 9:00	SOUTH LOOP ROOF Projection + DJ SOCIAL / 3 HR / \$18
SUN 5:30	RED LINE CINEMA Archive screening FOCUSED / 2 HR / \$10

01

**STAY
LATE**

.....

02

**FIND
YOUR
ROUTE**

.....

03

**THE CITY
STARTS
AFTER SIX**

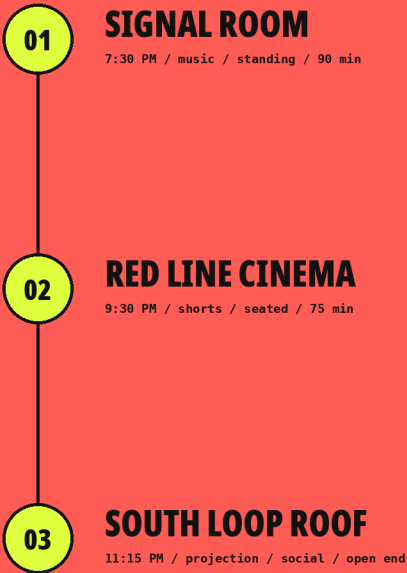
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04

**GO
ANYWAY**

.....

THREE STOPS. NO MASTER PLAN.



BEST FOR / A GROUP THAT WANTS MOMENTUM

A NIGHT WITH ROOM TO BREATHE.

01

NIGHT LIBRARY

6:00 PM / reading room / free

02

EAST DOCK STUDIO

7:45 PM / open print lab / \$12

03

BLUE HOUR HALL

9:45 PM / listening session / \$8

BEST FOR / SOLO OR TWO PEOPLE / LOW PRESSURE

DESIGNED TO BE FOLDED, MARKED, AND KEPT.

TRIM

5.5 x 8.5 in

Compact enough to carry; large enough for listings and images.

PAPER

80 lb uncoated text

Tactile, low-glare, and friendly to pencil or pen.

BINDING

Two-staple saddle stitch

Economical short-run binding with a visible, honest construction.

COLOR

CMYK digital print

Bright palette translated through proofing rather than assumed from screen.

PAGES

20 + cover

A multiple of four for saddle-stitch imposition.

COVER

100 lb uncoated cover

Enough body to protect the interior without feeling rigid.

BLEED

0.125 in

Color and imagery extend beyond trim; critical content remains inside the safe area.

COMPANION

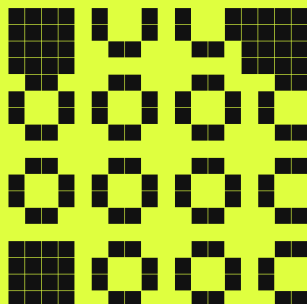
11 x 17 foldout + postcards

Extends navigation and campaign value beyond the zine.



NIGHT SHIFT

AFTER-HOURS CULTURE GUIDE



**GO OUT.
LOOK AROUND.
STAY A LITTLE.**

ILLUSTRATIVE PRINT-PRODUCTION PROTOTYPE / 2026

jocelynmartinez.design / night-shift

